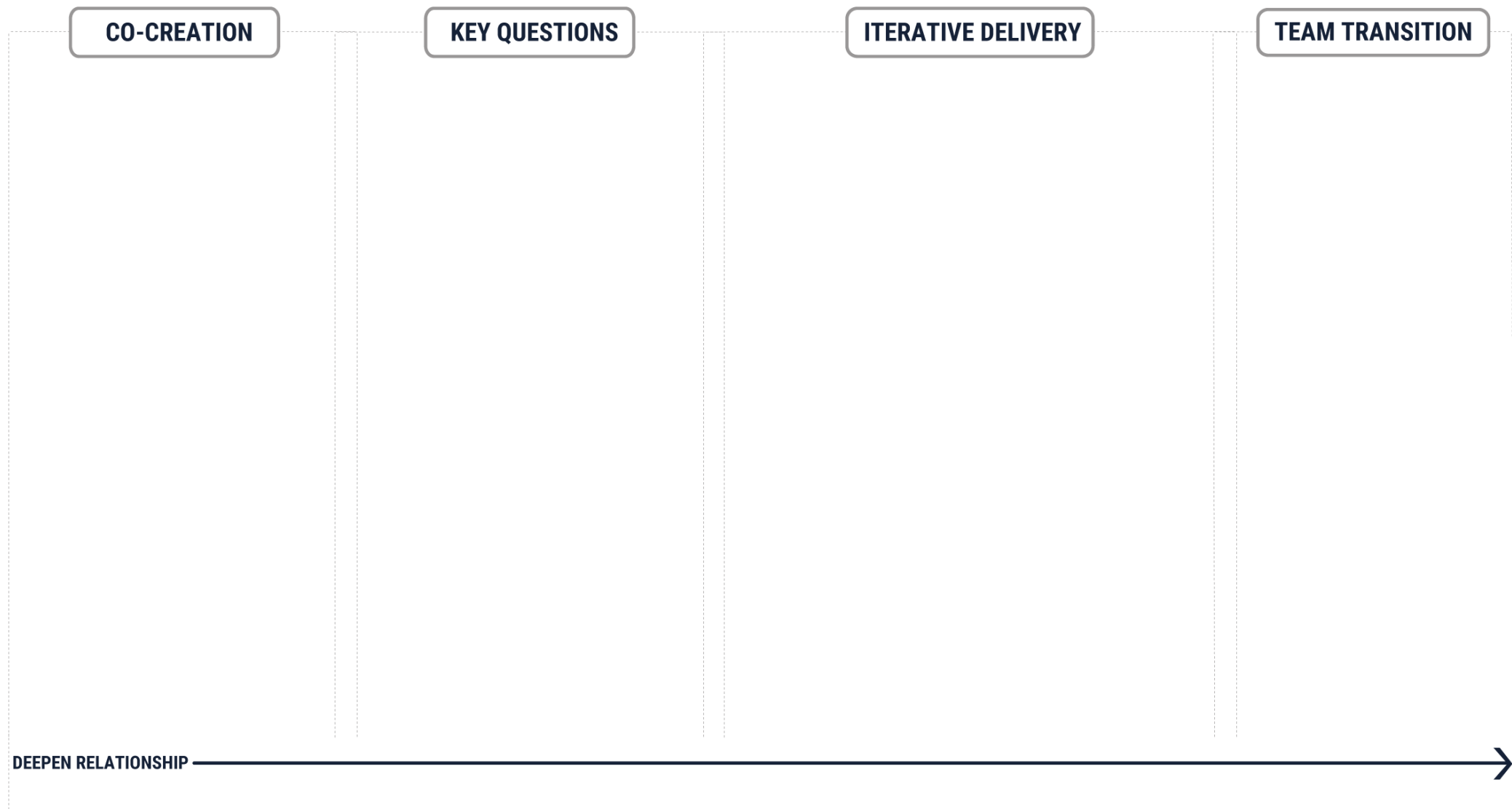
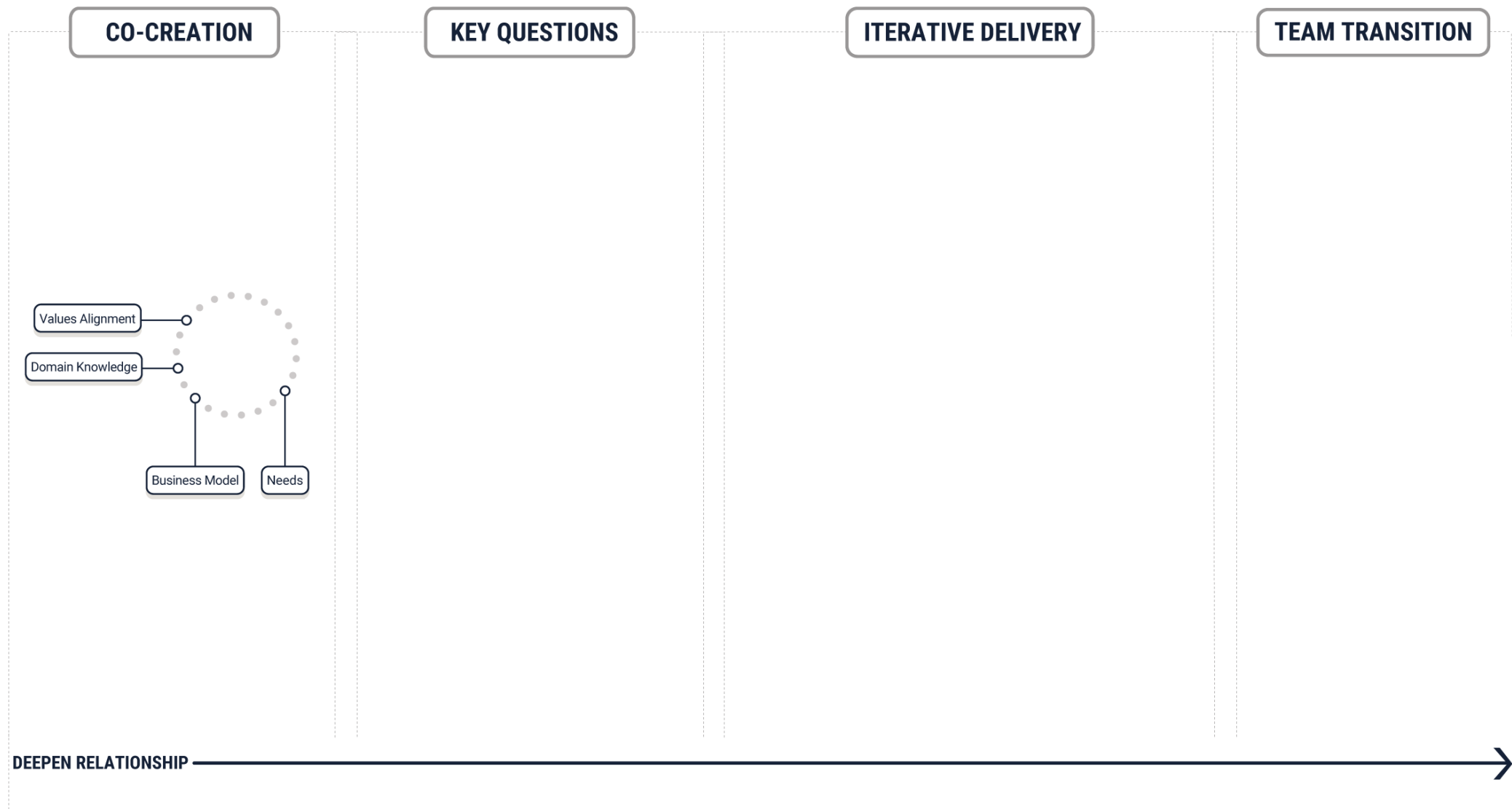
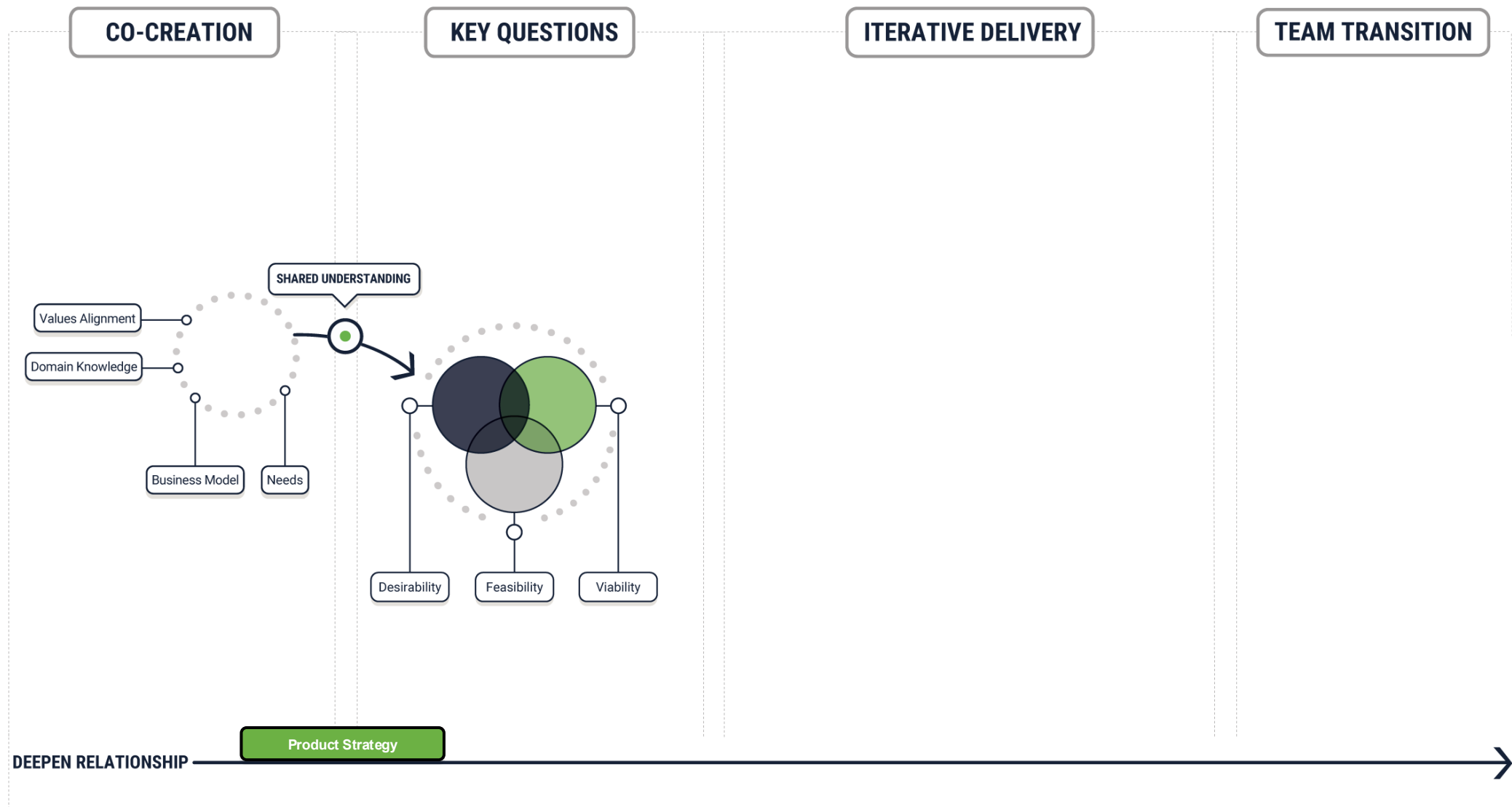


Tools for a Shared Understanding

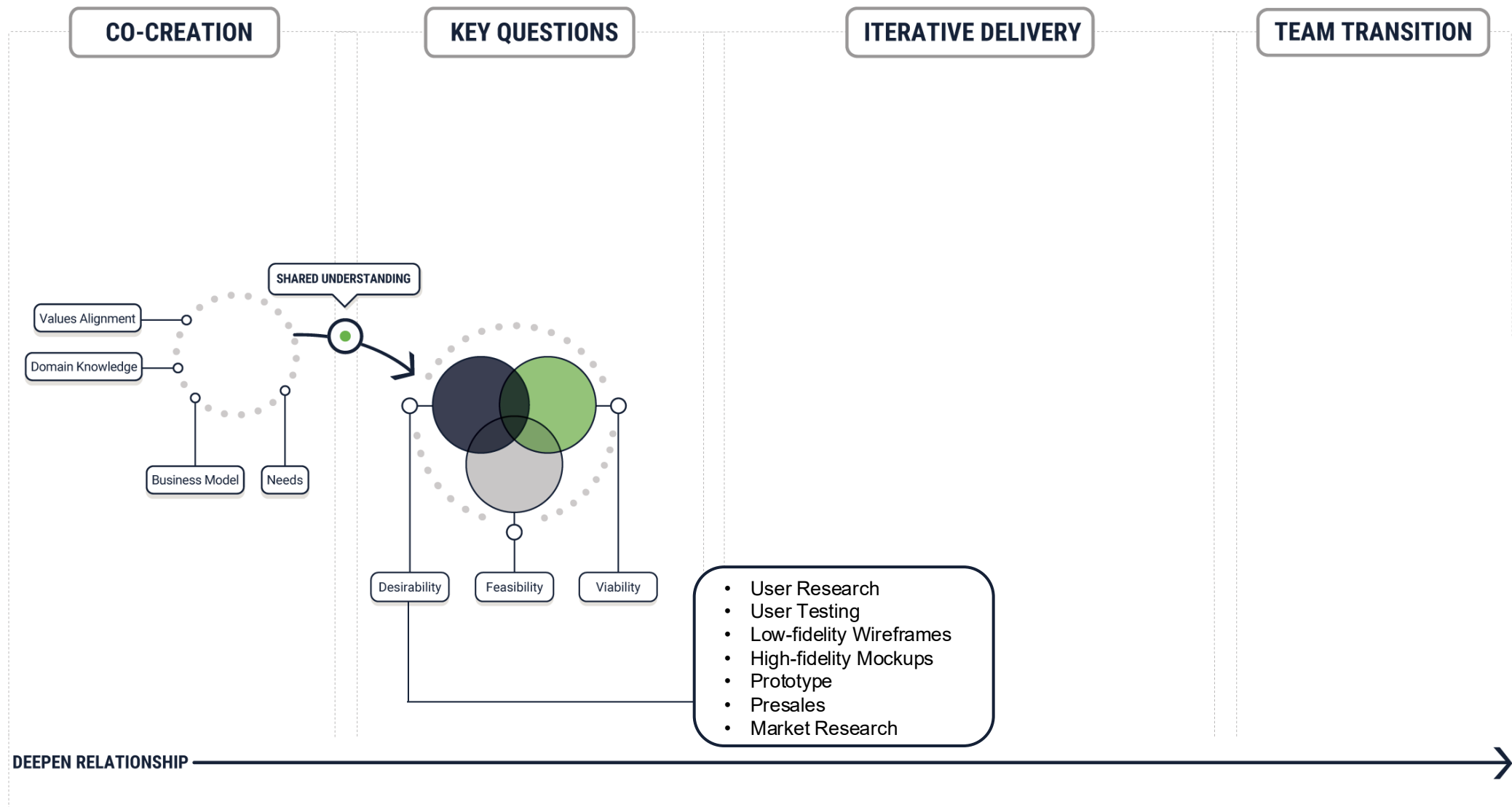
Visualizing Requirements with
Journey Maps,
Lean Canvas Model, and
Sequence Diagrams

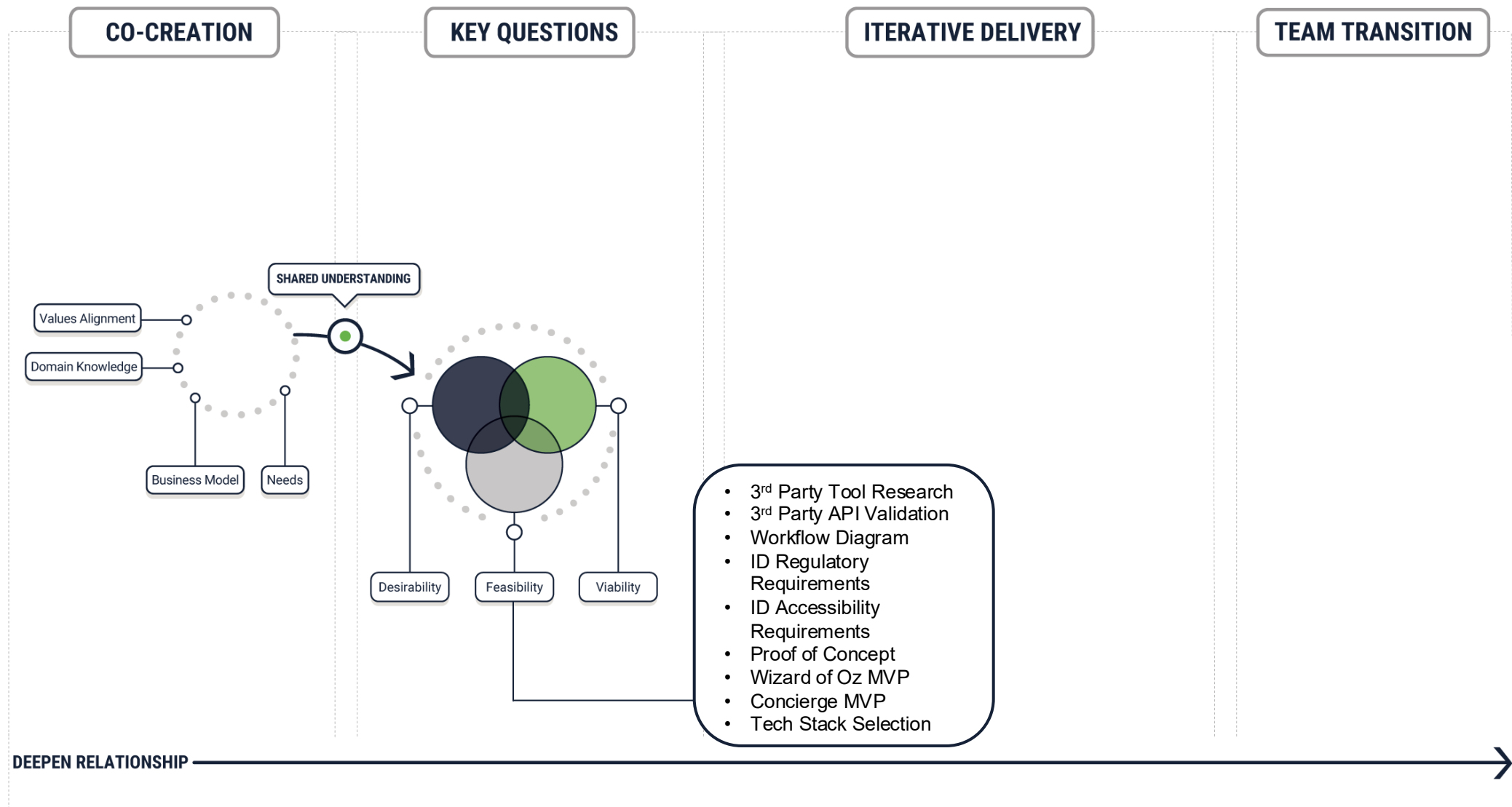


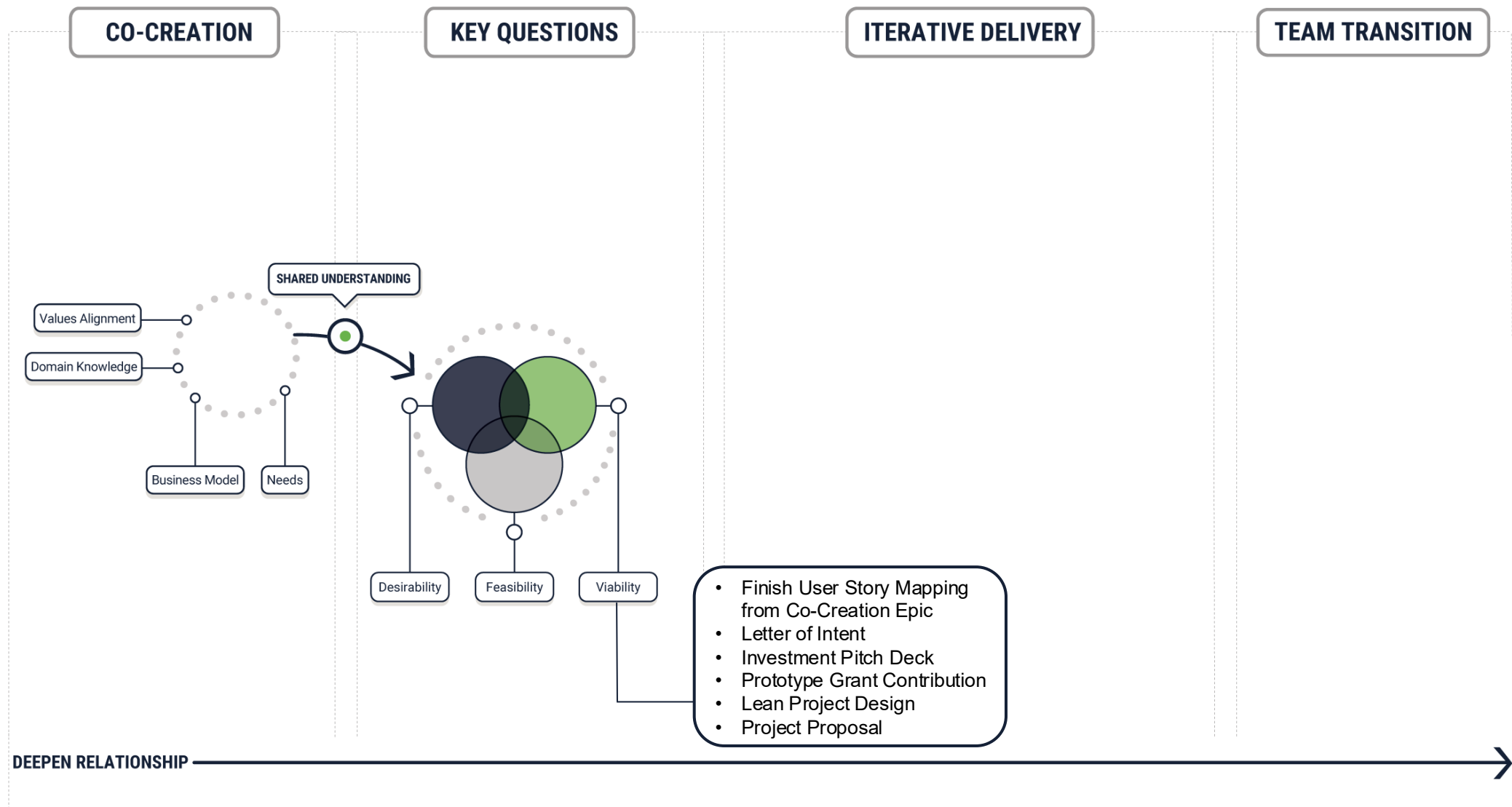


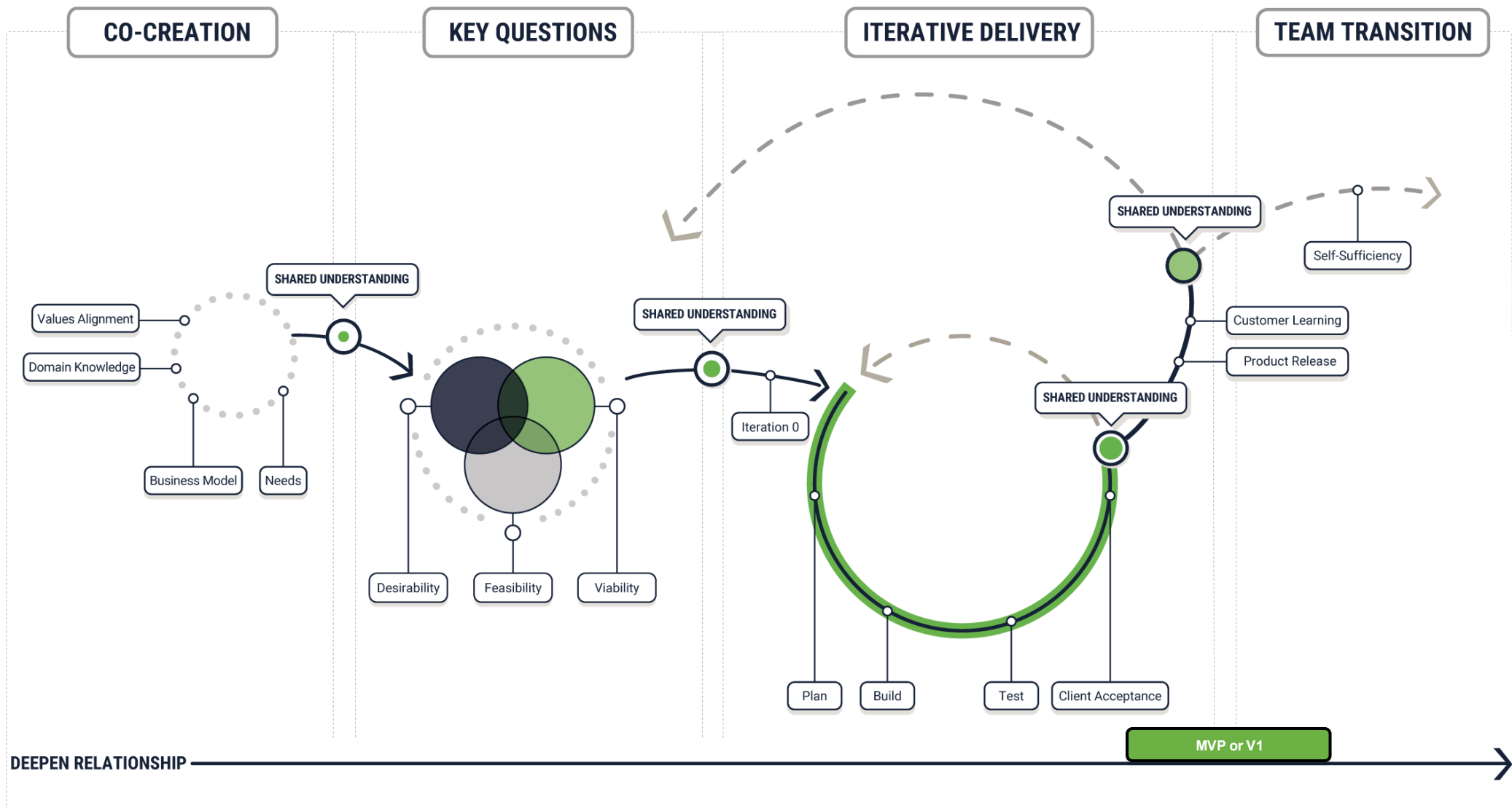


YOUR VISION + OUR ENGINEERING









Motivation

Why do tools which allow us to visualize requirements work?



1

How the customer explained it



2

How the project leader understood it



3

How the analyst designed it



4

How the programmer wrote it



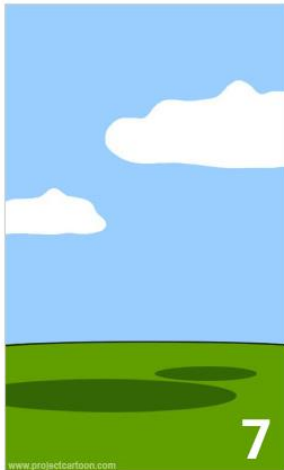
5

What the beta testers received



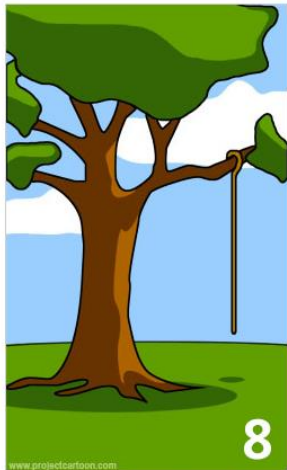
6

How the business consultant described it



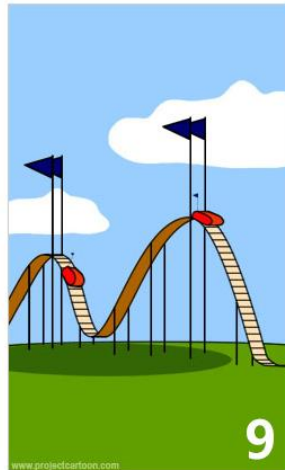
7

How the project was documented



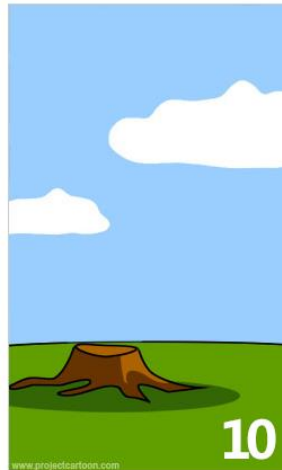
8

What operations installed



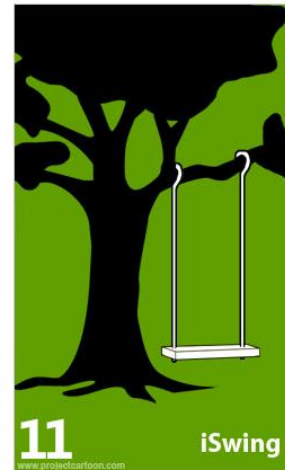
9

How the customer was billed



10

How it was supported



11

iSwing

What marketing advertised



12

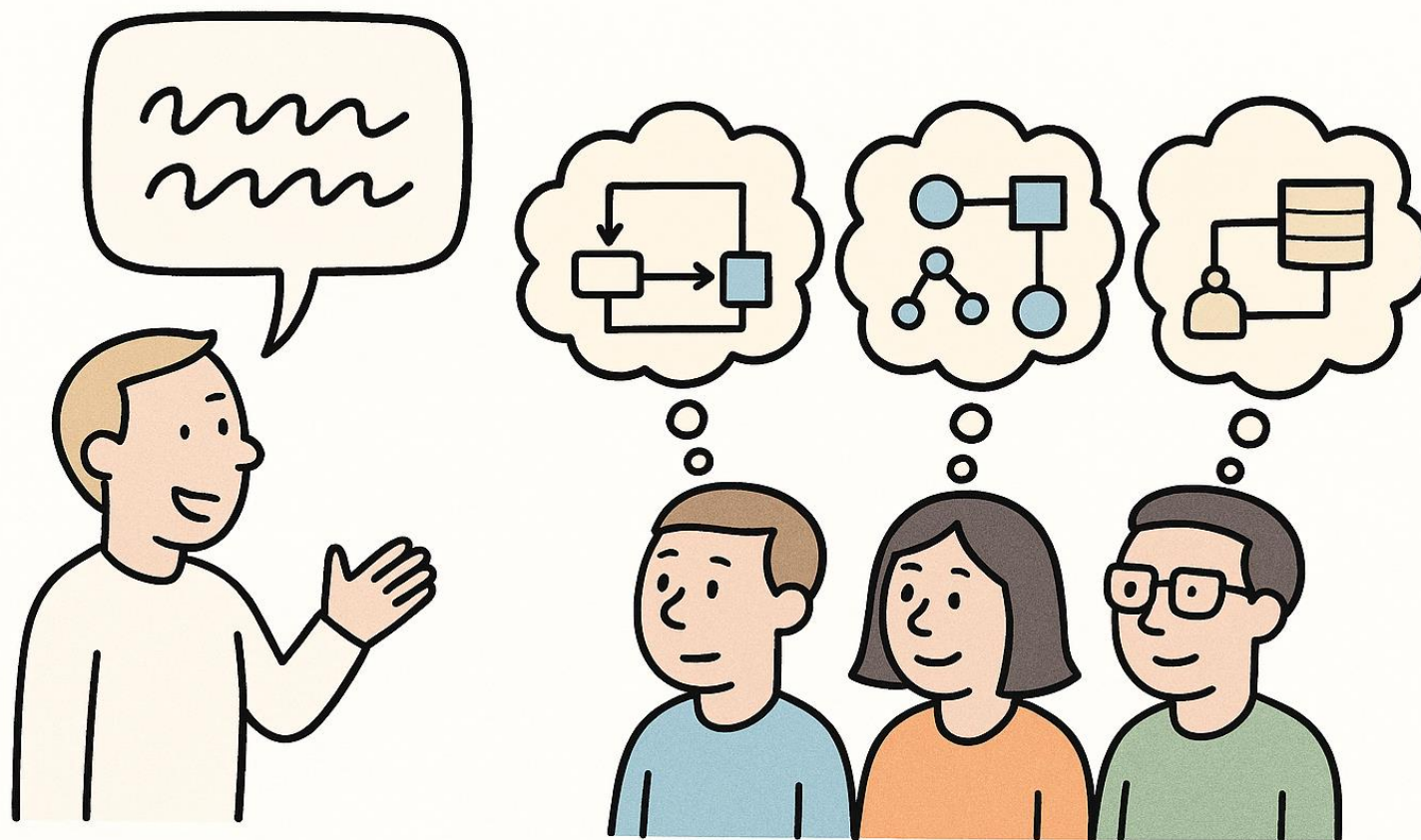
What the customer really needed

Key Challenges

- We want to ensure...
 - we build what we should be building
 - we have a sufficiently shared understanding
- Two problems...
 - Our assumption that we all have a shared picture
 - Our assumption that all assumptions and requirements are known



Same words, different mental models. Shared understanding is critical.



Same words, different mental models. Shared understanding is critical.

Working through complex problems

- Goal of Critical Thinking Tools:
 - Create a shared understanding of requirements → design
 - Gain increased clarity prior to implementation
 - Increase the value of outside input on design
 - Improve the quality and completeness of the requirements
 - Improve the quality of estimates
 - Maintain the design integrity of the system

“Design thinking is a human-centered approach to innovation that draws from the designer’s toolkit to integrate the needs of people, the possibilities of technology, and the requirements for business success.”

Tim Brown, Executive Chair of IDEO

<https://designthinking.ideo.com/>

Journey Maps

Understand user emotions and pain points clearly

Why do I?

- To stop arguing about features and start agreeing on the human problem.
- To surface friction, confusion, and risk that never show up in a requirements list.
- To make invisible work visible. Especially handoffs, waiting, and emotional cost.
- To align engineers, product, and stakeholders on what actually matters before we build anything.

When should I?

- When people disagree but can't articulate why.
- When requirements feel “right” but outcomes keep missing the mark.
- When the system crosses teams, tools, or organizations.
- Early enough to change direction cheaply, but late enough that the problem is real.

How do I?

- Start with a real person doing a real thing, not a persona doing a scenario.
- Map actions, decisions, and feelings. Especially the moments of uncertainty.
- Focus on transitions and handoffs. That's where systems fail.
- Use it to ask better questions, not to document answers.

Activity: Fill in a journey map

Market to Market Relay

What is the Market to Market Relay

- It's a day-long team running relay race where teams of 6–8 runners cover about 75 miles from Omaha to downtown Lincoln.
- Each runner runs multiple legs of 3–5 miles while the team supports each other and travels together in a van.
- The course mixes trails, paved streets, and gravel back roads and includes fun elements like costumes and a big post-race celebration.
- It's one of the largest day-long relays in the United States and sells out every year, making it a high-demand running “road trip.”

<https://www.markettomarketrelay.com/locations/nebraska/>

1. How it Works

The Market to Market® Relay Nebraska is a team running relay from the Omaha Metro to Lincoln, covering around 75 miles over several stages on a scenic and varied course. Join 6, 7, or 8 of your closest pals, hop in a van, run, rest and repeat. The course follows trails, paved streets and gravel back roads through a diverse and scenic slice of Nebraska. Combine the running with outrageous costumes, memorable van rides, and a lively Post-Race Shindig & Expo in downtown Lincoln and it all adds up to 1 unforgettable day

2. Team Size

Choose to run with a 6, 7 or 8-person team. Go to the My Team page to invite teammates to your team.

3. Distance

Each runner completes 2-3 legs of varying difficulty. Most legs range from 3 to 6 miles, so most runners average between 9 to 15 total miles for the day. You got this!

4. Vehicles

All teams are allowed 1 vehicle per team. Most teams go with a van, mini-van or SUV. Get creative and win the Best Decorated Vehicle contest!



<https://www.markettomarketrelay.com/locations/nebraska/course-details/#the-course>

☰

Market to Market Relay N...

🔍

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▼

Course Map for the Market to Market Relay Nebraska.

☆

2,176,790 views

Published on October 13

SHARE

✓

Market to Market Relay Nebraska | Route...

▼

🏃 Runners Route

📍 Start/Stage 1 | Seymour Smith Park

📍 Stage 2 | Twin Creek

📍 Stage 3 | Halleck Park

... 19 more

✓

Driving Route

▼

📍 Start/Seymour Smith to Twin Creek

📍 Twin Creek Cinema to Halleck Park

📍 Halleck Park to SumTur

📍 SumTur to Vita Nova

... 15 more

✓

Parking Lots - On

▼

📍 Seymour Smith - Parking

📍 Twin Creek - Parking

📍 Halleck Park - Parking

📍 SumTur - Parking

... 16 more

This map was created by a user. [Learn how to create your own.](#)

Map data ©2025 Google [Terms](#) 2 mi

Problem statements (from 2017ish)

- We have runners who are finishing too late (or early)
- We believe we could have more teams.

Share time